

Absolutely — **local** is a strong secondary polysemy target because your passage uses it here:

> “...which has helped them carve out a niche in the **local area**.”

Here **local** means **belonging to, connected with, or happening in the nearby area/community**. But the word also has important meanings in **local people, local government, transport, computing, medicine/anatomy, and mathematics**.

Word family: **local / locally / locality**

Base word: local

Adverb: locally

Related noun: locality

Part of speech: adjective (形容詞) / noun (名詞)

Meaning in your passage: **local = relating to the nearby area — 本地的；當地的；附近的**

Your phrase:

> “the **local area**”

Here **local** means:

> **connected with the particular place nearby, rather than somewhere distant or national/international.**

繁體中文：

與附近這個地區、社區或城市範圍有關的；本地的、當地的

Natural translation:

> “the local area”

「**本區 / 當地一帶**」

So here:

> **local = 與 Golden Crust 所在社區附近有關的**

1. **local = relating to a nearby place/area — 本地的；當地的**

The core meaning.

Practice 1 — Original

> “The bakery has built a niche in the **local area**.”

「這間麵包店在**本區 / 當地一帶**建立了自己的特色定位。」

Practice 2

> “Local shops depend on regular customers.”

「**本地商店**很依賴熟客。」

Practice 3

> “She knows the local neighbourhood well.”

「她很熟悉**當地社區**。」

local = 與某個特定附近地區有關，而不是較遠地方或全國性的

2. **local** = produced/grown/supplied nearby — 本地生產的；本地出產的

A very common food/business sense.

Practice 4

> “The bakery uses **local ingredients**.”

「這間麵包店使用**本地食材**。」

Practice 5

> “They sell local honey.”

「他們出售**本地出產的蜂蜜**。」

local = 在附近地區生產、種植、製作或供應的

This is very relevant to food businesses.

3. **local** = belonging to people in the area — 當地人的；本地社區的

Practice 6

> “The bakery has strong **local support**.”

「這間麵包店得到很強的**本地社區支持**。」

Practice 7

> “Local residents complained about the traffic.”

「**當地居民**投訴交通問題。」

local = 與居住 / 工作在該地區的人有關的

4. **a local** = local resident/person — 當地人；本地居民

Now **local** is a noun.

Practice 8

> “The café is popular with **locals**.”

「這間咖啡店很受**當地人**歡迎。」

Practice 9

> “Ask a local for directions.”

「向一位**當地人**問路吧。」

a local = 住在某地、對當地很熟悉的人

Very common.

5. **the locals** = 當地居民；本地人

Practice 10

> “The bakery is well loved by **the locals**.”

「這間麵包店很受**當地居民**喜愛。」

Practice 11

> “The locals know which cafés are best.”

「**當地人**知道哪些咖啡店最好。」

the locals = 某地區的居民作為一個群體

6. **local = operating within one area rather than nationally/internationally — 地區性的；本地營運的**

A business/media/institutional sense.

Practice 12

> “It is a **local business**, not a national chain.”

「這是一間**本地小企業**，不是全國連鎖店。」

Practice 13

> “The story was covered by local media.”

「這則消息由**本地媒體**報道。」

local = 服務 / 營運範圍主要限於某個地區，而不是全國或國際

Common:

- * local business
- * local newspaper
- * local radio
- * local media

7. **local government = 地方政府；地方行政機關**

A major institutional compound.

Practice 14

> “The **local government** supports small businesses.”

「**地方政府**支持小型企業。」

Practice 15

> “Local government is responsible for several public services.”

「**地方行政機關**負責多項公共服務。」

local government = 負責某城市、地區或地方行政範圍的政府機構

8. **local authority** = 地方政府機構；地方主管機關

A common BrE/institutional term.

Practice 16

> “The **local authority** approved the plan.”

「**地方政府機構**批准了這個計劃。」

Practice 17

> “Businesses must follow local authority regulations.”

「企業必須遵守**地方主管機關**的規定。」

local authority = 負責某地區公共行政的地方政府單位

Register:

* especially BrE

9. **local** = nearby transport/service — 區內的；本地線的

A transport/logistics use.

Practice 18

> “Take the **local train**, not the express.”

「乘搭**普通站站停列車 / 區間車**，不要搭快車。」

Practice 19

> “The local bus stops near the bakery.”

「**區內巴士 / 本地巴士**會在麵包店附近停站。」

local = 服務較小地區、停站較多，而非長途 / 快速服務的

This is especially common with trains.

10. **local = affecting only one part of the body — 局部的**

A major medical/anatomical meaning.

Practice 20

> “The patient received a **local anaesthetic**.”

「病人接受了**局部麻醉**。」

Practice 21

> “There was local swelling around the injury.”

「傷口周圍有**局部腫脹**。」

local — medical = 只影響身體某一特定部位，而不是全身性的

This is a genuinely distinct technical sense.

11. **local anaesthetic = 局部麻醉劑**

A major medical compound.

Practice 22

> “The dentist used a **local anaesthetic**.”

「牙醫使用了**局部麻醉劑**。」

Practice 23

> “The procedure can be done under local anaesthetic.”

「這個程序可以在**局部麻醉**下進行。」

****local anaesthetic = 只令身體某一部位暫時失去感覺的麻醉藥****

12. ****local = stored/processed on your own device/system — 本機的；本地端的****

A major computing sense.

Practice 24

> “The file is stored on the ****local drive****.”

「檔案儲存在****本機磁碟****。」

Practice 25

> “The app can run on a local server.”

「這個應用程式可以在****本地伺服器 / 本機伺服器****上運行。」

****local — computing = 位於使用者自己的電腦 / 裝置 / 網絡環境內，而不是遠端 / 雲端****

Common:

* local file

* local drive

* local server

* local network

13. ****local network = 區域網絡；本地網絡****

Practice 26

> “The computers are connected through a ****local network****.”

「這些電腦透過****區域網絡****連接。」

Practice 27

> “The printer is available on the local network.”

「打印機可透過**本地網絡**使用。」

****local network = 在有限地理 / 技術範圍內連接裝置的網絡****

14. ****local = limited to a particular part of a system/problem — 局部的 ; 區域性的****

A broader technical/analytical use.

Practice 28

> “The problem appears to be ****local****, not system-wide.”

「這個問題似乎是****局部性的****，不是整個系統都有問題。」

Practice 29

> “The change had only a local effect.”

「這個變化只有****局部影響****。」

****local = 只限制在某個部分 / 區域，不影響整體****

This concept links medicine and computing.

15. ****local = relating to a small region in mathematics — 局部的****

A mathematical/technical sense.

Practice 30

> “The function has a ****local maximum****.”

「這個函數有一個****局部極大值****。」

Practice 31

> “We first examine the local behaviour of the function.”

「我們先研究這個函數的****局部行為****。」

****local — mathematics = 只考慮某點附近的小範圍，而不是整個定義域****

Common:

* local maximum

* local minimum

* local behaviour

16. ****local = nearby branch/version of a wider organisation — 地方分部的；本地支部的****

Practice 32

> “She joined the ****local branch**** of the organisation.”

「她加入了該組織的****本地分部****。」

Practice 33

> “The local office handles customer enquiries.”

「****地方辦事處****負責處理客戶查詢。」

****local = 屬於較大型組織、但負責某一地區的****

17. ****locally = in the nearby area — 在本地；當地****

Practice 34

> “The bread is made ****locally****.”

「這些麵包是****本地製作****的。」

Practice 35

> “Most ingredients are sourced locally.”

「大部分食材都是****在本地採購****的。」

****locally = 在附近地區 / 本地進行或取得****

18. **locally = only in one part/area — 局部地**

A technical extension.

Practice 36

> “The cream works **locally** on the skin.”

「這種藥膏只在皮膚上**局部發揮作用**。」

Practice 37

> “The software stores some data locally.”

「這套軟件會把部分資料**儲存在本機**。」

locally = 在特定部位 / 本機 / 小範圍內，而非整體或遠端

19. **locality = area/place — 地區；地點**

A useful related noun.

Practice 38

> “The bakery is well known in the **locality**.”

「這間麵包店在**當地一帶**很有名。」

Practice 39

> “Several cafés operate in the same locality.”

「幾間咖啡店都在同一**地區**營業。」

locality = 某個具體地區 / 地方

Register:

* formal

* administrative/geographical

20. **locality = property of being local / spatial proximity (技術) — 局部性**

A technical family meaning.

Practice 40

> “The system is designed to improve data **locality**.”

「這個系統旨在改善資料**局部性** / 就近存取性。」

Practice 41

> “Locality can affect computing performance.”

「資料**局部性**會影響電腦運算效能。」

locality — computing/science = 資料、作用或現象集中於相近位置 / 範圍的特性

Secondary/technical.

Important distinction: **local** vs **nearby**

nearby

= physically close.

local

= belonging to or serving the surrounding area.

> nearby bakery

> = 附近的麵包店

> local bakery

> = 本地 / 社區麵包店

A local business may not be the closest one to you.

Important distinction: **local** vs **neighbourhood**

local

broad adjective:

= belonging to the area.

neighbourhood

often refers to a smaller immediate residential/community area.

> local business

> = 本地生意

> neighbourhood bakery

> = 街坊 / 社區麵包店

The latter feels more community-oriented.

Important distinction: **local vs regional**

local

smaller, more immediate area.

regional

larger geographical region covering multiple local areas.

> local newspaper

> = 本地報紙

> regional newspaper

> = 地區性報紙

Important distinction: **local vs national**

local

= limited to a particular town/area.

national

= across the whole country.

> local chain

> = 地方連鎖

> national chain

> = 全國連鎖

Important distinction: **local vs international**

local

= nearby/domestic area.

international

= involving more than one country.

> local customers

> = 本地顧客

> international visitors

> = 國際訪客

Important distinction: **local vs native**

local

= connected with the place currently being discussed.

native

= originating naturally/from birth in a particular place.

> local resident

> = 當地居民

> native species

> = 原生物種

Someone can be local without being native-born.

Important distinction: **local vs locally produced**

local product

can mean:

> associated with the area

locally produced

specifically:

> actually made/produced nearby

Important for food marketing.

Important distinction: **local — geographical vs medical**

Geographical:

> local bakery

> = 本地麵包店

Medical:

> local anaesthetic

> = 局部麻醉

Same core idea:

> limited to one particular area

but very different domain.

Important distinction: **local — geographical vs computing**

Geographical:

> local area

> = 當地一帶

Computing:

> local file

> = 本機檔案

In computing, the “area” is the user’s own device/system rather than physical neighbourhood.

Important distinction: **local file vs cloud file**

local file

= stored on the current device.

cloud file

= stored on remote internet servers.

So:

> local = 本機端

> cloud/remote = 雲端 / 遠端

Important distinction: **local maximum vs maximum**

local maximum

= highest value only within a nearby range.

global/absolute maximum

= highest value over the entire domain.

Important mathematical contrast.

Important distinction: **a local vs local**

Adjective:

> “a local bakery”

= 本地麵包店

Noun:

> “a local told me about it”

= 一位當地人告訴我

Same form, different part of speech.

Important distinction: **locals vs local people**

Both mean:

> 當地人

But:

* **locals** = concise, natural conversational noun

* **local people/residents** = more explicit/formal

Family-extension sweep

After the full audit, the useful modern family includes:

* **local — nearby area** = 本地 / 當地的

* **local — locally produced** = 本地生產 / 出產的

* **local — residents/community** = 當地人的

* **a local / locals** = 當地人 / 居民

* **local — limited business/media scope** = 地區性的

* **local government** = 地方政府

* **local authority** = 地方主管機關

* **local transport** = 區內 / 站站停服務

* **local — medicine** = 局部的

* **local anaesthetic** = 局部麻醉

* **local — computing** = 本機 / 本地端的

* **local network** = 區域網絡

* **local — limited system effect** = 局部性的

* **local — mathematics** = 局部的

* **locally — geographical** = 在本地

* **locally — technical** = 局部 / 本機地

* **locality — place** = 地區 / 地點

* **locality — technical** = 局部性

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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local — geographical	與附近某個特定地區、社區或城市範圍有關的
local — produced nearby	在附近地區種植、製作、生產或供應的
local — community	與住在 / 活動於該地區的人有關的
a local	居住在某地並熟悉當地的人
local — business/media	服務 / 營運範圍主要限於某個地區的
local government	負責某城市 / 地區行政事務的地方政府
local — transport	服務較小地區或停站較多、非快速 / 長途的
local — medicine	只影響身體某一特定部位，而非全身性的
local — computing	位於目前裝置 / 本地系統內，而非遠端或雲端的
local — system	只限制在某個部分 / 區域，不影響整體的
local — mathematics	只考慮某點附近小範圍，而非整體範圍的
locally	在本地；或在特定局部 / 本機範圍內
locality — geographical	某個具體地方 / 地區
locality — technical	作用 / 資料集中在相近位置或範圍的特性

For your original sentence

> “...which has helped them carve out a niche in the ****local area****.”

The exact meaning is:

****local = Golden Crust 所在的附近社區 / 地區範圍，而不是更廣泛的全市、全國或國際市場。****

Natural translation:

> ****「這一點幫助他們在本區建立了自己的特色定位。」****

The highest-value contrasts are:

- > ****local area**** → 本地 / 附近地區
- > ****local business**** → 本地企業
- > ****local ingredients**** → 本地食材
- > ****a local**** → 當地人
- > ****local government**** → 地方政府
- > ****local train**** → 區間 / 站站停列車
- > ****local anaesthetic**** → 局部麻醉
- > ****local file**** → 本機檔案
- > ****local maximum**** → 局部極大值
- > ****local vs nearby**** → 屬於本地的 vs 距離很近的